Women and SC, ST and OBC representation across the IISERs

What public data show, how the IISERs compare with India as a whole, and what the data cannot show. A report for IISER student councils

iGEM IISER Kolkata 2026 · Inclusivity team · Contact: team.igem@iiserkol.ac.in

Summary:

1. **Women are a minority of students and faculty at every IISER, and institutes differ widely.** Among UG five-year students the share runs from 27.2% to 51.8%; among regular faculty from 12.0% to 23.2%. Women are a smaller share of faculty than of students at every institute.
2. **Against India, the IISERs enrol many women but have few on the faculty.** Pooled, women are 40.4% of IISER UG students, close to the 41.3% for all universities and well above the 26.5% for Institutes of National Importance (INIs). Women are 18.8% of IISER faculty, below the INI figure of 22.1% and far below India's 44.9%. The fall from UG to faculty is 21.6 points at the IISERs, against 4.4 at INIs and 4.6 for India.
3. **There is no general decline.** Since 2017-18 women's share of students rose at Mohali, Thiruvananthapuram and Kolkata and fell slightly at Pune. Among current faculty, women are a larger share of recent joiners: 14% of those who joined up to 2012 and 25% of those who joined from 2022 (seven IISERs pooled).
4. **SC, ST and OBC students together are 47.6% of IISER students** (4,418 of 9,276), close to the 49.5% central seat reservation and the 46.3% for INIs, and below the 62.9% of UG students in India. Pune's share has fallen steadily since 2017-18; Berhampur's latest figure is probably a reporting change.
5. **Students against faculty percentages for SC, ST and OBC categories.** Nationally, INI faculty are 26.1% from these communities against 46.3% of INI students.
6. **The home state does not explain the differences between institutes,** for women or for categories. With seven or eight institutes the test is weak, but the same "no link" appears between institutes and within them over time.
7. **Institutes sit in a narrow band whatever the host state's mix.** SC, ST and OBC shares at the institutes span 12.7 points, while the shares among all students in their host states span 30.5 points. That fits a national admission process, not a local one.
8. **The numbers that matter most are not public:** SC and ST separately, PhD students and faculty by category and gender, where students come from, and admissions' procedures details. One institute (Kolkata) has so far given us faculty counts by category.

How to read the numbers

- Student figures count everyone enrolled in a programme across all its years, so they move slowly and **cannot show the mix of a single year's new entrants**.
- Institutes **self-report** the NIRF data themselves
- **Years.** NIRF year Y describes students in the academic year (Y−2) to (Y−1), so NIRF 2026 means 2024-25. Faculty lists are snapshots in year Y. "Latest" means 2024-25 for students and the 2026 list for faculty, except Mohali (2023-24 and 2025), whose later files we could not get. Bhopal has one NIRF file and Tirupati two.
- **Regular faculty** means people listed as currently working with association type "Regular". Contractual, visiting and other appointments are left out. Where the list marks the director this way, the director is counted.
- **National benchmarks** come from AISHE, the Ministry's survey of all higher education [2]. AISHE counts all teachers, not only regular faculty; its "Institutes of National Importance" category mixes the IITs, NITs, AIIMS, IIMs and IISERs; and it cannot name institutes. Differences of a few points between an institute and a national figure are not meaningful.
- **The 49.5% line** is 15% SC + 7.5% ST + 27% OBC, the central seat reservation in admissions [3]. We use it as a reference, not a target or a verdict. Students admitted on open seats are probably counted in the NIRF column too, so a share above the line can be legitimate.
- **Gender** is recorded only as male or female, so these data cannot show non-binary or gender-diverse people.

1. Your institute at a glance

Institutes are listed alphabetically. Percentages are shares of people, as submitted to NIRF. Appendix A gives every year.

Table 1. Latest year available for each institute. Student years are academic years; faculty years are NIRF list years. The range row gives the highest minus the lowest of the seven IISERs, in percentage points. Source: NIRF submissions [1].

Institute	Women among UG five-year students	Women among regular faculty	SC, ST and OBC among UG and PG students
Berhampur	43.7% (2024-25)	12.0% (6 of 50; 2026)	40.3% (2024-25)
Bhopal	39.3% (2024-25)	20.1% (35 of 174; 2026)	48.1% (2024-25)
Kolkata	27.2% (2024-25)	14.4% (18 of 125; 2026)	47.0% (2024-25)
Mohali	39.9% (2023-24)	17.4% (20 of 115; 2025)	48.2% (2023-24)
Pune	27.6% (2024-25)	21.8% (31 of 142; 2026)	45.1% (2024-25)
Thiruvananthapuram	51.6% (2024-25)	19.5% (22 of 113; 2026)	50.5% (2024-25)
Tirupati	51.8% (2024-25)	23.2% (16 of 69; 2026)	52.9% (2024-25)
All seven pooled	40.4% (3,289 of 8,146)	18.8% (148 of 788)	47.6% (4,418 of 9,276)
Range across the seven (points)	24.5	11.2	12.7

Institute	Women among UG five-year students	Women among regular faculty	SC, ST and OBC among UG and PG students
IISc Bangalore (reference)	16.9% (4-year UG, 2024-25)	10.0% (48 of 482; 2026)	49.7% (2024-25)

Notes on individual rows

- **Berhampur.** The category share (40.3%) is much lower than in its two earlier files (47.1% and 48.7%). We think this is a change in reporting, not in who was admitted (Section 4).
- **Bhopal.** One NIRF file only (2026). Bhopal also runs a four-year undergraduate programme, where women are 19.8% (114 of 575); we do not compare it with the five-year programmes.
- **Kolkata.** The institute's own count of faculty is 131 and excludes the director; NIRF lists 125 as "regular" (Section 6).
- **Mohali.** Student figures are for 2023-24 and the faculty list is 2025, because later files were not available to us.
- **Pune.** The category share has fallen steadily since 2017-18 (Section 4).
- **Thiruvananthapuram.** Women's share of students peaked at 55.3% in 2022-23.
- **Tirupati.** Two NIRF files only, so trends cannot be judged.
- **IISc Bangalore** is not an IISER and is shown for reference. Its undergraduate programme is four years, so its student figure is not comparable with the five-year programmes.

2. India against the IISERs and IISc

2.1 Stage by stage

Figure 1 lines up each stage for India as a whole, for all universities, for the Institutes of National Importance (INIs, the AISHE category that includes the IISERs), and for the IISERs and IISc. Table 2 gives the numbers behind it.

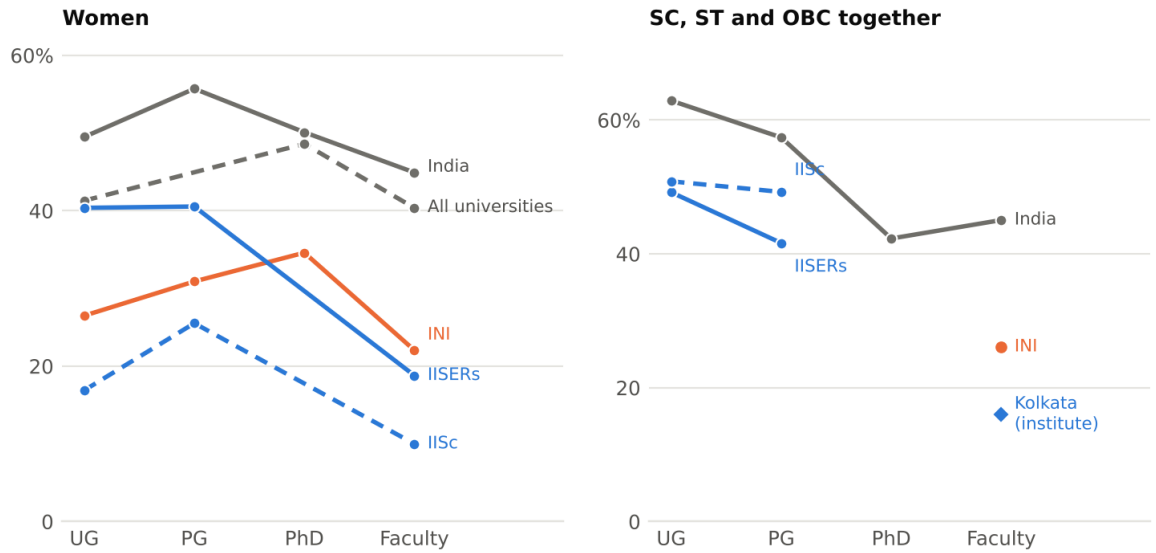


Figure 1: Women, and SC, ST and OBC together, at each stage. Left: women. Right: SC, ST and OBC. India, all universities and INI: AISHE 2023-24 [2]. IISERs: UG five-year and all PG programmes (five IISERs report PG), faculty pooled over seven. IISc: four-year UG. The Kolkata point is the institute's own figure (Section 6). Gaps in a line mean no figure.

	IISERs	**IISc**	**INI**	**All universities**	**India**
Women, UG students	40.4% (range 27.2–51.8)	16.9%	26.5%	41.3%	49.5%
Women, PG students	40.5% (range 31.3–51.2; five IISERs)	25.5%	30.9%	–	55.7%
Women, faculty	18.8% (range 12.0–23.2)	10.0%	22.1%	40.4%	44.9%
SC, ST and OBC, UG students	49.2% (five IISERs)	50.8%	–	–	62.9%
SC, ST and OBC, PG students	41.6% (five IISERs)	49.3%	–	–	57.4%
SC, ST and OBC, all UG and PG students	47.6% (range 40.3–52.9)	49.7%	46.3%	49.8%	–
SC, ST and OBC, faculty	16.0% (Kolkata only)	–	26.1%	31.2%	45.1%

Table 2. IISERs and IISc against national benchmarks. IISER and IISc figures are from NIRF (latest year); INI, all universities and India are from AISHE 2023-24. India's SC, ST and OBC figures for UG and PG are shares of UG and PG enrolment. A dash means we have no comparable figure.

Women. In India as a whole women are 49.5% of UG students, 55.7% of PG students and 50.1% of PhD students, and 44.9% of teachers, a fall of 4.6 points from UG to faculty. In INIs the shares are lower throughout (26.5%, 30.9%, 34.6% and 22.1%), and the fall from UG to faculty is 4.4 points. The IISERs start much higher than INIs: 40.4% of their UG five-year students are women, close to the 41.3% for all universities. But women are 18.8% of IISER faculty, below the INI figure, so the fall from UG to faculty is 21.6 points. IISc, at 16.9% of UG students and 10.0% of faculty, falls 6.9 points.

Three cautions apply:

1. The stages are different groups of people: today's faculty were students a decade or two ago, so the fall is not the loss of the same women.
2. The INI category is a mixture, and its low UG share partly reflects institutes where women are few, so the IISERs' advantage over INIs at UG level is partly a matter of what is in the category.
3. AISHE counts all teachers while we count regular faculty.

SC, ST and OBC. In India as a whole these groups are 62.9% of UG students, 57.4% of PG students, 42.3% of PhD students and 45.1% of teachers. The five IISERs that report both levels have 49.2% in UG and 41.6% in PG, so they sit 13.7 points below India at UG level, and the step down from UG to PG is 7.6 points against 5.5 for India. IISc has 50.8% in UG and 49.3% in PG. For faculty we have a category figure at one IISER only. National and state figures are affected by state OBC lists and quotas that differ from the central ones, so the India-wide student figure is not a central-quota benchmark.

2.2 Women, institute by institute

Figure 2 sets each institute against the national lines. Among UG students, Tirupati and Thiruvananthapuram (about 52%) are above the India-wide 49.5%. Berhampur, Mohali and Bhopal (39% to 44%) are around the 41.3% for all universities. Pune and Kolkata (about 27%) are at about the INI average of 26.5%, and every other IISER is above it. Among faculty, Tirupati (23.2%) and Pune (21.8%) are close to the INI average of 22.1%, and Bhopal, Thiruvananthapuram, Mohali, Kolkata and Berhampur are below it. All are far below the India-wide 44.9% and the 40.4% for all universities.

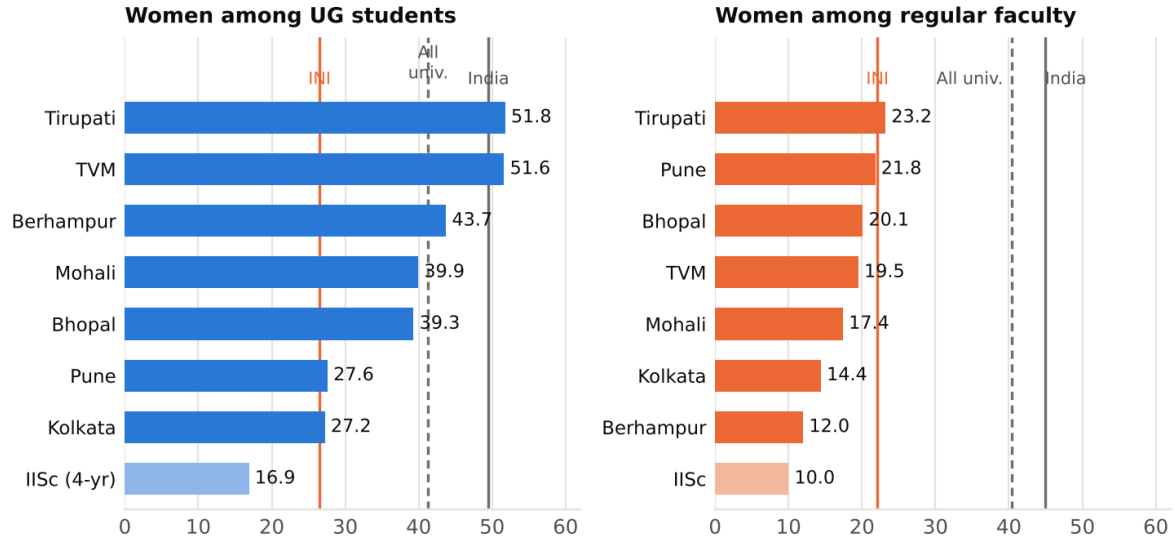


Figure 2: Women among UG students and among regular faculty, against national figures. Vertical lines: AISHE 2023-24 [2]. IISc: four-year UG programme. Source: NIRF [1].

2.3 SC, ST and OBC students, institute by institute

NIRF reports one combined number for students from these communities. Across the seven IISERs it is 47.6% (4,418 of 9,276), close to the 49.5% seat reference and to the 46.3% for INIs (Figure 3). Shares run from 40.3% to 52.9%, and the differences between institutes are larger than chance alone would give ($\chi^2 = 43.4$, 6 degrees of freedom, $p < 0.001$). Pune and Berhampur are clearly below the 49.5% line, Tirupati is above it, and the intervals for Kolkata, Bhopal, Mohali, Thiruvananthapuram and IISc include it. Every institute is well below the 62.9% of UG students in India.

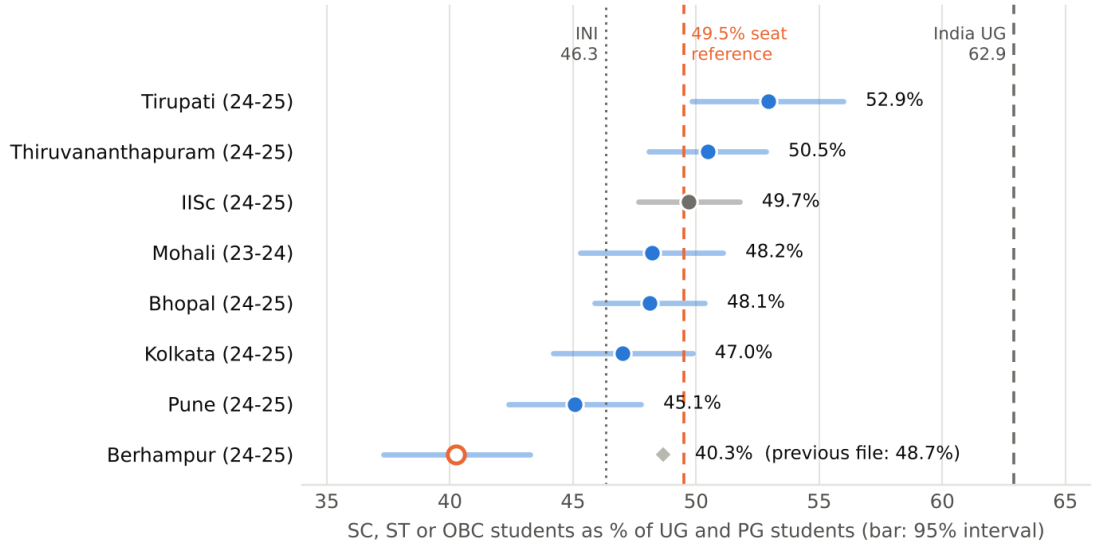


Figure 3: Share of SC, ST and OBC students, latest year. Dots show the share; bars are 95% intervals. Dashed orange line: 49.5% seat reference. Dotted line: INI students, all levels (AISHE). Dashed grey line: India, UG students (AISHE). The year in brackets is the academic year of the data. Source: NIRF [1] and AISHE [2].

2.4 The host state as context

Each institute sits in a state, and AISHE reports students and teachers by state. Figure 4 asks whether an institute looks like the higher-education system around it. The institutes recruit nationally, so this is context, not a test of cause.

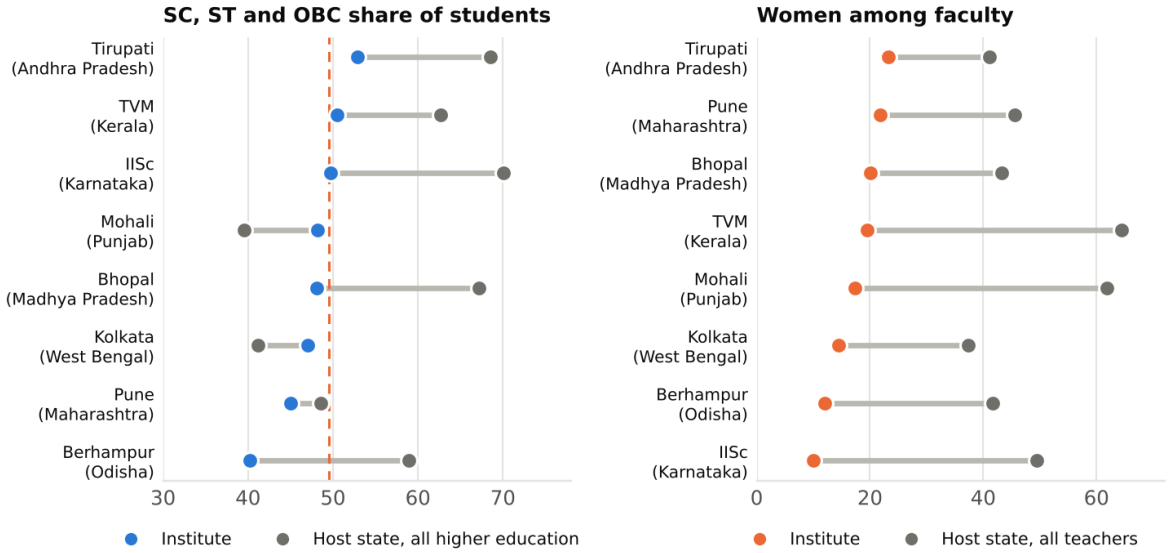


Figure 4: Institutes against their host states. Left: SC, ST and OBC share of students, institute against all students in the host state (AISHE 2023-24, all levels and colleges). Right: women among faculty, institute against all teachers in the host state. Source: NIRF [1] and AISHE Tables 14 and 21 [2].

Category. The institutes' shares span 12.7 points (40.3% to 52.9%), while the host states' shares among all students span 30.5 points, from 39.6% in Punjab to 70.1% in Karnataka. Mohali (+8.6 points) and Kolkata (+5.8) are above their host states, Pune is 3.5 below, and the other five are 12 to 20 points below. The rank correlation between institute and host state is 0.52 ($p = 0.18$, $n = 8$), positive but not distinguishable from

zero. Institutes cluster near 48% whatever the host state's mix, which fits a national admission process. Two cautions: state OBC lists differ from the central list and push some southern states' figures up, and the state figures cover all colleges and all levels.

Women among faculty. Every institute is below its host state's share of women among all teachers, by 18 points (Tirupati) to 45 points (Thiruvananthapuram). The host-state shares run from 37.4% (West Bengal) to 64.5% (Kerala) and are unrelated to the institute's share (rank correlation −0.10, p = 0.82, n = 8). State teaching staff are mostly in colleges and in fields where women are many, so this is not a fair target for a research institute. It does show that the faculty share at an IISER is not a mirror of the local pool of women teachers.

3. Women

3.1 Students and faculty

In the latest year, women are 27.2% of UG five-year students at Kolkata and 27.6% at Pune, between 39% and 44% at Bhopal, Mohali and Berhampur, and about 52% at Tirupati and Thiruvananthapuram (Figure 5). Among regular faculty the range is 12.0% to 23.2%, and no IISER is above one in four. Pooled across the seven, women are 18.8% of regular faculty (148 of 788).

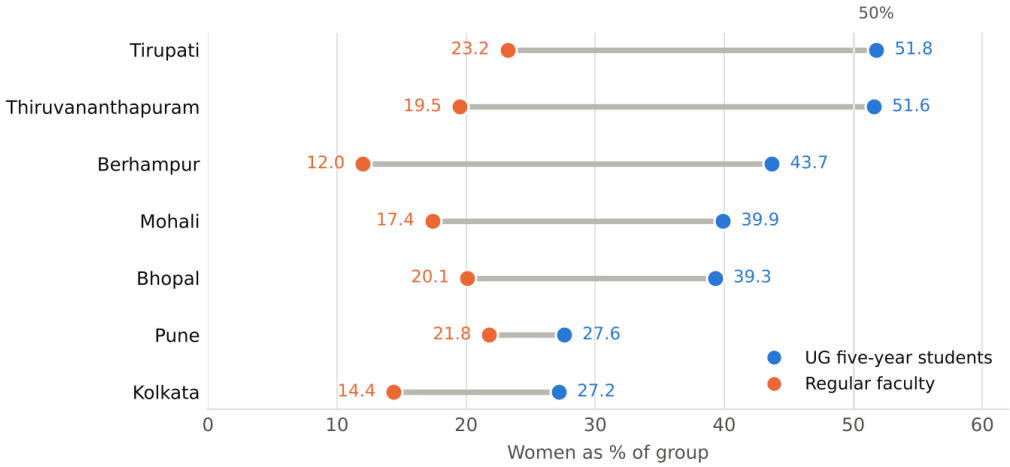


Figure 5: Women among UG five-year students and among regular faculty, latest year. Blue: students. Orange: faculty. Mohali: students 2023-24, faculty 2025. Source: NIRF [1].

Women are a smaller share of faculty than of students at every IISER. The difference is 6 points at Pune, 13 at Kolkata, 19 at Bhopal, 23 at Mohali, 29 at Tirupati and 32 at Berhampur and at Thiruvananthapuram. Across institutes the two shares are only weakly related (r = 0.22, n = 7): the institutes that enrol the most women do not have the most women on the faculty.

This should not be read as "students become faculty", that, of course is untrue. Faculty are recruited nationally, usually after a PhD and a postdoc, so the pool that matters is PhD students and postdoctoral researchers by gender. NIRF does not report that split.

3.2 Change over time

Among students there is no general decline since 2017-18 (Figure 6). Mohali rose from 32.5% to 39.9% by 2023-24. Thiruvananthapuram went from 47.2% in 2018-19 to a peak of 55.3% in 2022-23 and 51.6% in 2024-25. Kolkata rose from 24.2% to 27.2%, mostly in one step in 2020-21. Pune moved between 26.2% and 29.8% with no clear direction.

Among regular faculty, Thiruvananthapuram went from 10.2% in 2020 to 19.5% in 2026 as its faculty grew from 59 to 113 people. Pune rose from 17.6% to 21.8%, Mohali moved from 16.5% to 17.4%, and Kolkata stayed between 13.8% and 14.4% in every list since 2019 while its faculty grew from 108 to 125. Berhampur, Bhopal and Tirupati have too few lists to describe a trend.

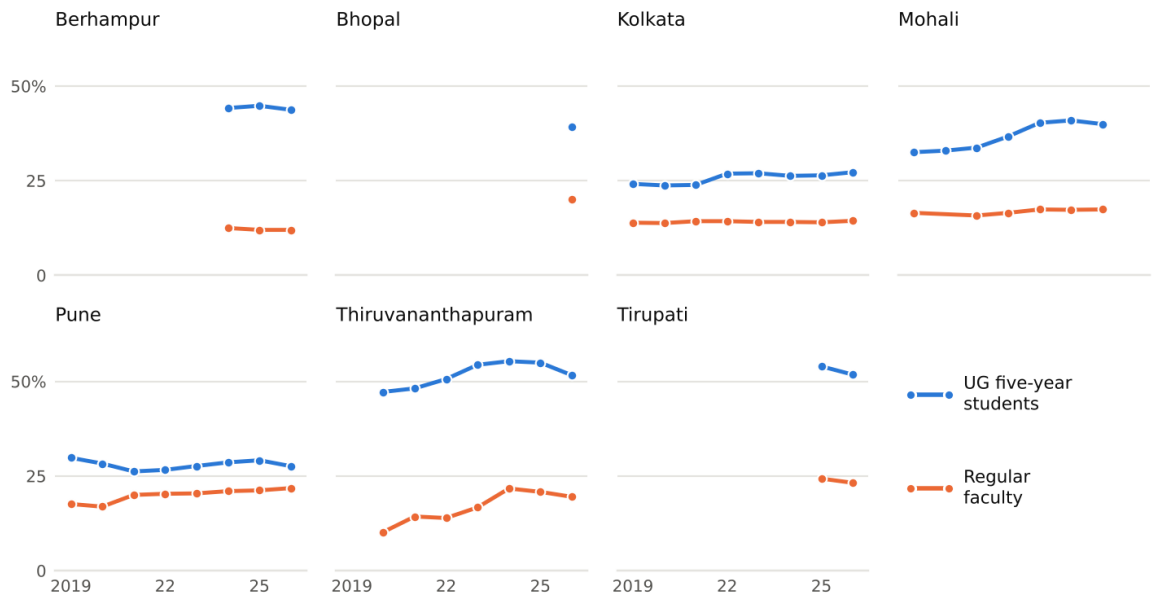


Figure 6: Women among UG five-year students and regular faculty over time. Each point is one NIRF year; students are plotted at the NIRF year that reports them. Lines start where files exist. Source: NIRF [1].

3.3 Who got the growth?

Seats grew at every institute, but not evenly for women. A share rises only if women are a larger share of the growth than of the starting group (Figure 7). Among students, women were 77% of the net growth at Mohali (from a 33% start), 57% at Thiruvananthapuram (47%) and 50% at Kolkata (24%), so their shares rose. At Pune they were 23% of the growth from a 30% start, so the share slipped. Among regular faculty, women were a larger share of the growth than of the start at every institute except Berhampur: 43% against 18% at Pune, 30% against 10% at Thiruvananthapuram, 21% against 16% at Mohali and 18% against 14% at Kolkata. At Pune and Thiruvananthapuram that meant 10 and 16 women added; at Kolkata and Mohali 3 and 5, so the share moved far less.

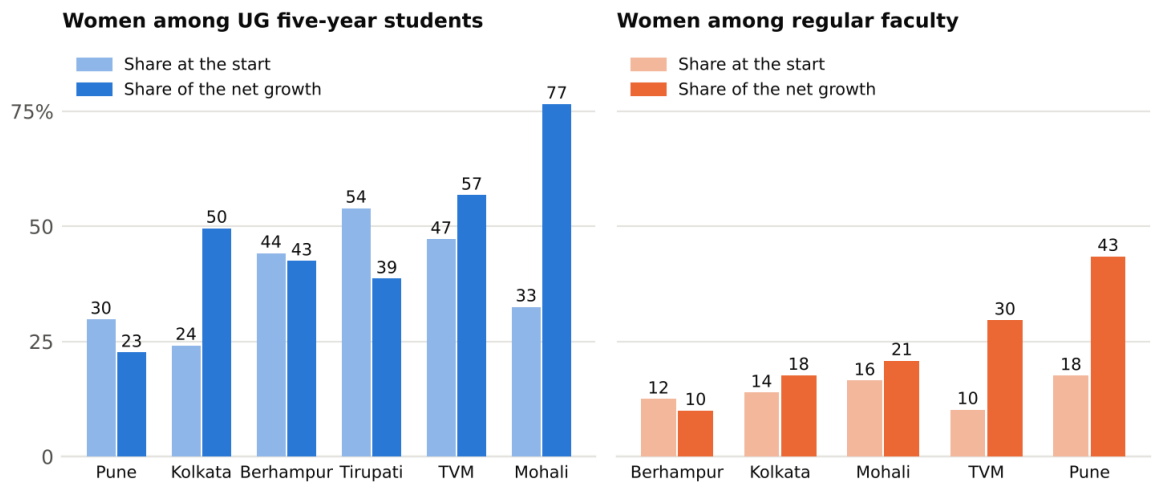


Figure 7: Share of women at the start and share of the net growth. Net change between a first and a latest file; periods differ by institute (students from 2017-18 at Kolkata, Pune and Mohali, 2018-19 at Thiruvananthapuram, 2022-23 at Berhampur, 2023-24 at Tirupati; faculty from 2019 or the first list available). Bhopal has one file and Tirupati's faculty has two lists with no net growth, so they are left out of the right panel. Net changes combine hiring and departures. Source: NIRF [1].

3.4 Who has been joining the faculty?

Among people on the latest lists, women are 14% of those who joined up to 2012, 17% of those who joined in 2013-17, 21% of those in 2018-21 and 25% of those who joined from 2022 (Figure 8). Hiring appears to have moved towards women over time. We can only count people still on the list, so anyone who joined and left is invisible, and cohorts at a single institute are small (often under 30 people), which is why we show them pooled.

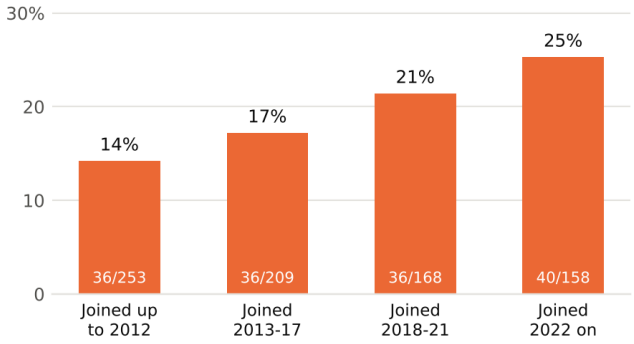


Figure 8: Women among current regular faculty, by period of joining. Seven IISERs pooled. Counts of women/total on each bar. Source: NIRF faculty lists [1].

3.5 Seniority

Pooled across the seven IISERs, women are 23% of assistant professors (66 of 290), 19% of associate professors (48 of 249) and 13% of professors and above (30 of 235), shown by institute in Figure 9. IISc follows the same order at lower levels (15%, 10% and 5%). Kolkata has the highest professor-level share of the seven (15%, 12 of 79) and Pune the highest associate-level share (30%). Most of the lower share at senior ranks reflects who was hired a decade or two ago (Section 3.4). These data cannot show whether

women are promoted more slowly or leave more often, which needs the same people followed across years. Groups under 10 people are drawn hollow because one person moves their share by 10 points or more, and "professor and above" includes dean and director titles that the NIRF form does not separate from rank.



Figure 9: Women among regular faculty by rank, latest list. One row per institute. Hollow marker: fewer than 10 people at that rank. At Tirupati the assistant and associate values are both 25% and overlap. Counts are in Appendix A5. Source: NIRF [1].

4. SC, ST and OBC students

4.1 Berhampur and the reliability of the column

Berhampur needs care. Its share was 47.1% and 48.7% in the two earlier files and 40.3% in the latest, while the institute added 183 students: the number of SC, ST and OBC students rose by only 2 (415 to 417). Some students leave each year, so this is not the category mix of the new entrants, but a rise of 2 against 183 is hard to reconcile with admission under reservation. In the same file its "economically backward" count rose from 10% to 37% of students. This looks more like a change in how the table was filled in than a change in who was admitted, but we cannot be sure. With its previous figure the seven-institute pool is 48.6% instead of 47.6%. If you are at Berhampur, we would welcome a correction.

We do not use the "economically backward" column. It swings implausibly between years and institutes (at Kolkata 15%, 12%, 28%, 27%, 35%, 9%, 9%, 10% in successive years), which suggests inconsistent definitions.

4.2 Change over time

Pune is the one clear trend: its share fell almost every year, from 49.5% in 2017-18 to 45.1% in 2024-25, about 0.8 points a year (95% interval −1.0 to −0.5). No other institute shows a trend we can tell from zero (Figure 10). Five one-year moves of more than 3 points occur at Berhampur, Kolkata and Mohali. For a stock of students in five-year programmes, a move that large in one year would need the incoming cohort to differ sharply from the one leaving, so we treat them as possible reporting changes.

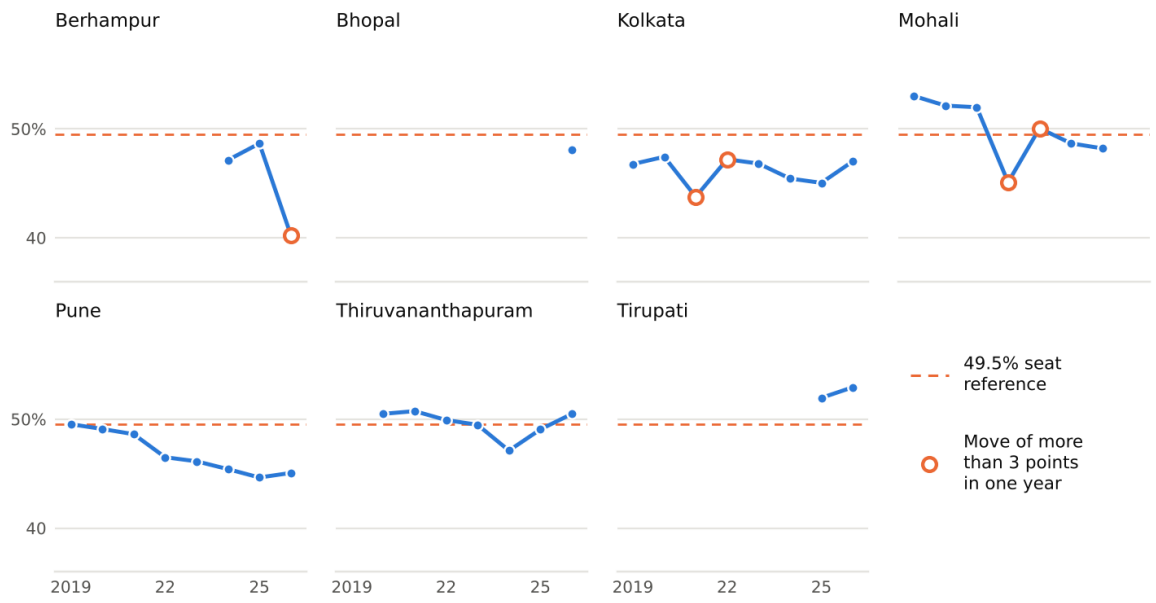


Figure 10: Share of SC, ST and OBC students over time. Each panel is one institute. Hollow points mark a one-year move of more than 3 points. Dashed line: 49.5%. Source: NIRF [1].

What could explain Pune? The data cannot say. Candidates are a change in the mix of admission routes over these years, growth in intake, or the way students are classified. Each would show up in admissions data by route and category, which the institute holds and NIRF does not report. We treat it as a question for the institute, not a conclusion.

4.3 Undergraduate against postgraduate

Five IISERs report both undergraduate and postgraduate students (Figure 11). For women, the postgraduate share is higher than the five-year share at Pune (40% against 28%) and Kolkata (33% against 27%), about equal at Thiruvananthapuram (51% and 52%), and lower at Tirupati (44% against 52%) and Bhopal (31% against 39%). For India as a whole the share of women rises from UG to PG (49.5% to 55.7%); pooled across these five IISERs it is flat (40.4% to 40.5%).

For SC, ST and OBC, the postgraduate share is lower at every one of the five: 41.6% (231 of 555) against 49.2% (3,221 of 6,546) pooled. Most of the difference is at Tirupati (29% against 55%); without it the gap is about 4 points and the evidence is weaker ($p = 0.06$). Both comparisons set admission routes into different programmes against each other, not the same students over time, and the PG groups are small (73 to 162 students).

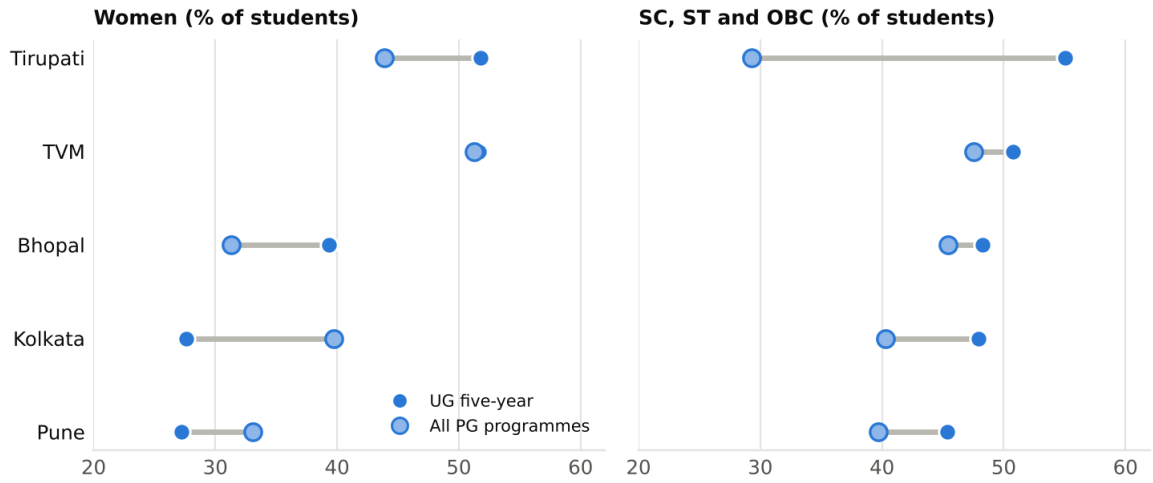


Figure 11: UG five-year and PG shares at the five IISERs that report both. Left: women. Right: SC, ST and OBC. Dark dots: UG five-year programme. Light dots: all postgraduate programmes. Latest year. Source: NIRF [1].

5. Does the home state explain it?

A common explanation for who joins an institute is local. An institute that draws mostly from its own state may reflect that state's population, and families may be more willing to send daughters to a nearby institute. NIRF lets us test a rough version, because it reports how many students come from within the institute's own state. Among UG five-year students that share runs from 6% at Mohali to 49% at Thiruvananthapuram (Figure 13).

5.1 Between institutes

Women. There is no link between the home-state share and the share of women among UG five-year students (Figure 12, left; r = −0.06, rank correlation −0.14, n = 7). Tirupati and Mohali take only 6% to 7% of their students from their own state and sit at opposite ends (51.8% and 39.9% women). Thiruvananthapuram and Kolkata take the most local students (49% and 39%) and are 24 points apart (51.6% and 27.2%).

SC, ST and OBC. The same holds for category (Figure 12, right; rank correlation −0.19, p = 0.65, n = 8 with IISc). Kolkata and Thiruvananthapuram both take more than 40% of their UG and PG students from their own state yet sit on opposite sides of the 49.5% line; Mohali, Bhopal, Tirupati and IISc take under 10% and are on both sides too. Leaving out Berhampur, whose latest figure is doubtful, the rank correlation is −0.07.

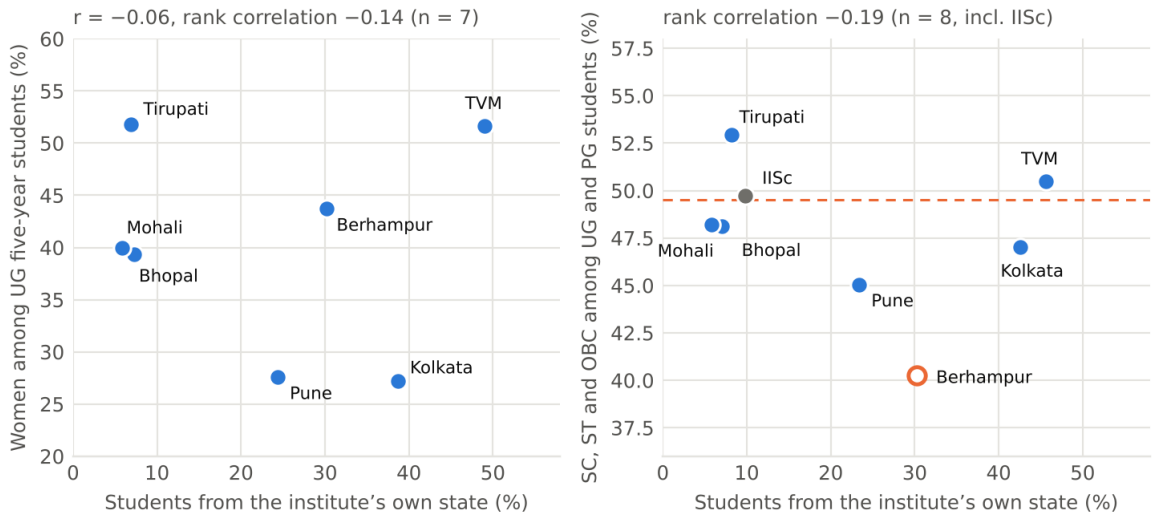


Figure 12: Home-state share against women's share and against SC, ST and OBC share. Latest year; each dot is an institute. Left: UG five-year students. Right: UG and PG students; the dashed line is 49.5%, the hollow point is Berhampur's doubtful 2026 figure. Source: NIRF [1].

5.2 Within institutes, over time

Thiruvananthapuram is the one institute where the home-state share moved a lot: from 68% in 2018-19 to 49% in 2024-25 (Figure 13), while women's share first rose from 47.2% to 55.3% and then eased to 51.6%. Pune, Mohali, Tirupati and Berhampur changed by less than 6 points and Kolkata rose from 35% to 39%. Taking the demeaned yearly changes of the five institutes with three or more files, the association between home-state share and women's share is r = −0.22 (33 institute-years, p = 0.21). For category it is r = 0.12 (41 institute-years, six institutes including IISc, p = 0.45). Consecutive years describe overlapping groups of students, so these p-values are optimistic. The point is that nothing appears within institutes either.

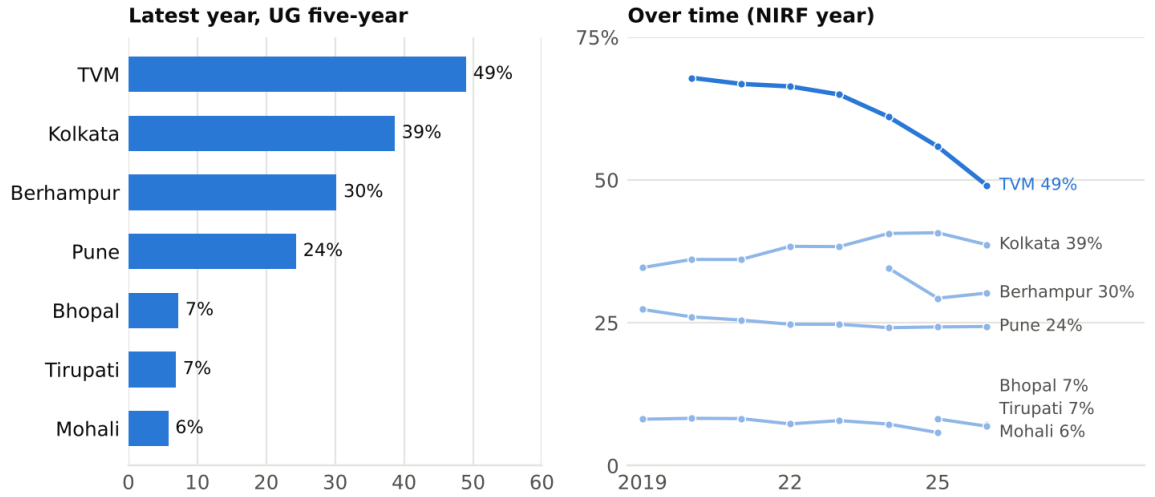


Figure 13: Share of UG five-year students from the institute's own state. Left: latest year. Right: by NIRF year; Thiruvananthapuram in dark blue. Source: NIRF [1].

5.3 How much can this show?

Table 3. Tests of the home-state and host-state explanations. Intervals for r are Fisher intervals. Source: NIRF [1], AISHE [2].

Question	n	Result	95% interval or p	Reading
Home-state share and women's share, between institutes	7	r = −0.06; rank −0.14	r: −0.78 to 0.72; p = 0.89	No link seen
Home-state share and category share, between institutes	8	rank −0.19; r = −0.28	p = 0.65; r: −0.82 to 0.53	No link seen
The same, without Berhampur	7	rank −0.07	p = 0.88	No link seen
Home-state and women, within institutes over time	33	r = −0.22	p = 0.21 (optimistic)	No link seen
Home-state and category, within institutes over time	41	r = 0.12	p = 0.45 (optimistic)	No link seen
Host-state share of students and institute category share	8	rank 0.52	p = 0.18	Weak, not clear
Host-state women among teachers and institute faculty share	8	rank −0.10	p = 0.82	No link seen

With seven or eight institutes these tests have little power. The 95% interval for the correlation with women's share runs from −0.78 to 0.72, so we cannot rule out even a fairly strong link in either direction. What we can say is that the data give no sign of one, and that the same absence shows up between institutes, within them, and against the host state. Home state is also a blunt measure: NIRF does not say which state a student comes from, so it cannot test regional access, for example for students from North East India.

6. SC, ST and OBC faculty

6.1 The national picture

NIRF has no category column for faculty. AISHE [2] does, but it cannot name institutes. In 2023-24 it counts 1.73 million teachers: 9.6% SC, 2.8% ST and 32.6% OBC, or 45.1% together. Four years earlier the figures were 9.0%, 2.4%, 32.1% and 43.5%. SC and ST remain well below 15% and 7.5%. OBC is above 27%, partly because state lists and rules differ from the central ones. Part of the rise in counts may come from more institutions reporting; shares are less affected than counts, but not immune.

Nationally, the shares fall between undergraduate level and the PhD, and faculty shares then sit close to the PhD share (Figure 14). Two cautions: today's faculty were PhD students years ago, so this compares different generations, and the AISHE PhD count jumped from 227,000 to 335,000 in 2023-24, probably from wider reporting. ST faculty (2.8%) are lower than the ST PhD share (4.1%), so for ST the last step loses more.

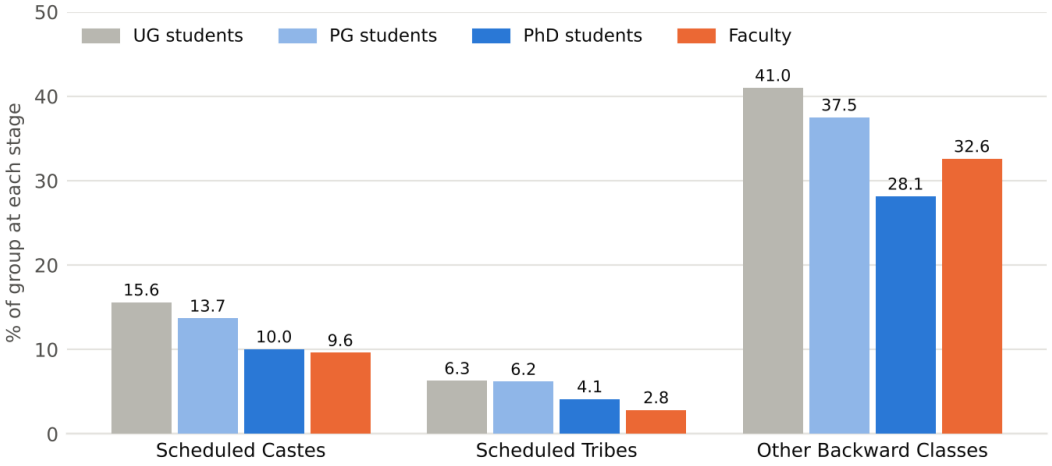


Figure 14: Share of SC, ST and OBC at each stage, India, 2023-24. Source: AISHE 2023-24 [2]; UG and PG shares from our AISHE student study, PhD from Table 11, faculty from Table 21.

6.2 Institutes of National Importance

The national picture hides a large difference by type of institution (Figure 15). In central universities the faculty share matches the student share (35.5% against 35.6%). In INIs, which AISHE reports together, faculty are 26.1% from these communities against 46.3% of students. AISHE cannot separate the IISERs from the rest of the category.

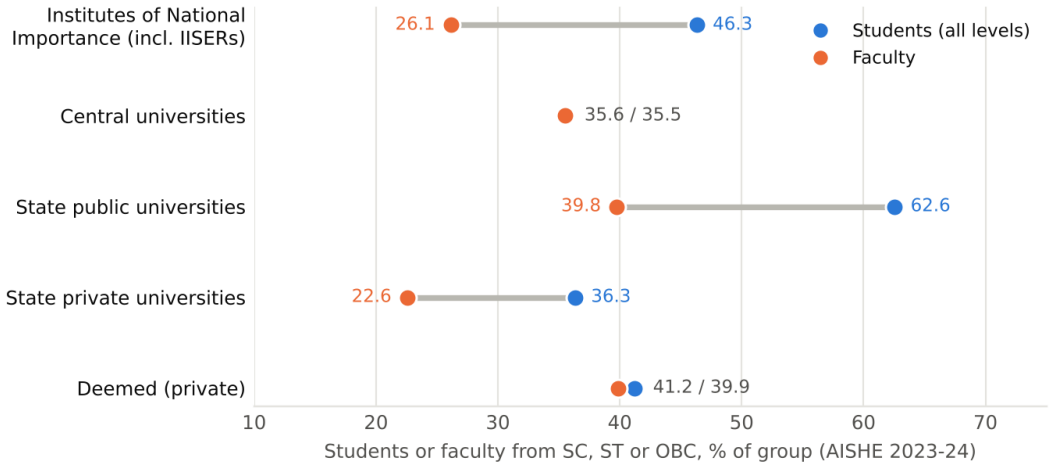


Figure 15: Share of SC, ST and OBC among students and faculty by type of university, 2023-24. Students at all levels in university teaching departments. Where the two values are within 3 points they are printed as students / faculty. Source: AISHE Tables 27 and 30 [2].

Over four years INI faculty rose from 21.0% to 26.1%, but the INI student share also rose (41.6% to 46.3%), so the difference of about 20 points has hardly changed. Of the net increase in INI faculty, 40.6% came from these groups, so new appointments are more diverse than the stock they join, but the stock changes slowly. Women are 22.1% of INI faculty, against 44.9% of all teachers in India, and SC women are 39.7% of SC faculty nationally against 44.9% for all faculty.

Across states, SC faculty share follows the local SC student share only loosely (0.43 points for each point), while ST (0.91) and OBC (0.84) follow it closely. That is what we would expect if SC faculty numbers

depend more on something national, such as the pool of SC PhD holders or recruitment, than on the local student population. The data cannot test this, and state averages mix very different institutions.

6.3 One IISER with category-wise faculty figures

So far only one IISER has given us faculty counts by category. IISER Kolkata's Dean of Faculty Affairs office gave us these figures for 131 faculty (the director is excluded): 110 general, 8 SC (6.1%), 1 ST (0.8%) and 12 OBC (9.2%). Together, 21 of 131 (16.0%; 95% interval 10.7% to 23.3%) are from SC, ST or OBC, against 47.0% of its students and 26.1% for INIs nationally.
These figures were supplied by the institute. We do not know whether "general" includes EWS candidates, and the comparison with AISHE is rough, because AISHE counts all teachers and these are regular faculty. We show it as an example of what becomes visible when the number exists, and to ask what the same count looks like at your institute.

7. Other angles

7.1 Absolute numbers rather than percentages

At institutes with 50 to 170 regular faculty, one appointment moves the women's share by 0.6 to 2.0 points (Table 4), so a change of a point or two between lists is not a trend. To give a sense of scale, the table also shows how many more women each institute would need on its present faculty to match the INI average of 22.1%. This is an illustration of size, not a target, and the INI average is itself a mixture.

Table 4. Women among regular faculty at present size, against the INI average from AISHE 2023-24. Source: NIRF [1], AISHE [2].

Institute	Women now (of regular faculty)	Needed for 22.1%	More needed	One appointment (points)
Berhampur	6 of 50 (12.0%)	12	+6	2.0
Bhopal	35 of 174 (20.1%)	39	+4	0.6
Kolkata	18 of 125 (14.4%)	28	+10	0.8
Mohali	20 of 115 (17.4%)	26	+6	0.9
Pune	31 of 142 (21.8%)	32	+1	0.7
Thiruvananthapuram	22 of 113 (19.5%)	25	+3	0.9
Tirupati	16 of 69 (23.2%)	16	0	1.4
IISc Bangalore (reference)	48 of 482 (10.0%)	107	+59	0.2

7.2 Gender varies more between institutes than category does

Between the seven IISERs the share of women among UG students spans 24.5 points, and the share of women among faculty 11.2 points, while the SC, ST and OBC share among students spans 12.7 points (7.8 without Berhampur). We assume that this is because the admission of women students does not mandate a compulsory reservation for them. On the other hand, students from SC, ST and OBC categories get a share of seats via reservation.

As for the low number of women students, women faculty and faculty from SC, ST and OBC categories, we have formed some hypotheses of our own after talking to the DoAA and DoFA at IISER K. We've also been talking to the women faculty and the women students at IISER Kolkata in an attempt to understand the trends in the data. We do have some interesting findings to share, do let us know if you'd like to see them. We'd be more than happy to share our findings with you.

7.3 Posts outside the regular faculty

Besides regular faculty, the NIRF lists include people in contractual, visiting and other appointments: 61 at the seven IISERs in their latest lists. Of these 16 (26%) are women, against 18.8% of regular faculty. The group is small and institutes use the types differently, so we draw no conclusion. It would be worth asking whether women are over-represented in non-permanent posts. We have, however, not considered this data set in our reports.

8. What the public data cannot show

- **SC and ST separately.** NIRF combines SC, ST and OBC for students. Nationally ST students are 6.3% of UG enrolment [2]; we do not know the figure at any IISER.
- **PhD students and postdocs by gender and category,** and **faculty by category,** at any IISER. NIRF gives PhD totals only, and no faculty category.
- **Where students come from.** NIRF records only "within state", "outside state" and "outside country", so it cannot show, for example, how many students come from different states or from regions like North East India.
- **Applicants, offers and joiners** by gender, category and admission route. Without them we cannot say whether a narrow share arises in who applies, who is offered a place or who joins.
- **Field of work.** Faculty lists do not give the department, so we cannot say whether women or reserved-category faculty are concentrated in certain subjects.
- **IISERs inside the INI category.** AISHE reports INIs together, so it cannot say whether the IISERs differ from the IITs, NITs or AIIMS.

9. What we would like from you, and what we can share

What we would ask

1. **Check your institute's row** (Table 1 and Appendix A) against what you know, and tell us where it is wrong or out of date. Berhampur's 2026 category figure and the years we could not get (for example Mohali 2026) matter most.
2. **Tell us what already exists.** If your council, the SC/ST cell, a women's cell or an institute committee has counted or tried something similar, we would like to learn from it, credit it, and avoid repeating it.
3. **Consider asking for the missing numbers.** Whether and how to ask is your decision. If your council wants to aggregate counts of faculty and PhD students by gender and category are the most useful. The other useful data could be:

- Domicile data of students by batch

- Category and gender wise separated data of students (BS-MS, PhD as well as post docs)
- Similar data for all faculty. It would be even better if the data is also segregated by rank and department
- The numbers of male and female students opting for different departments (when we compiled this data for IISER Kolkata, we came across some very interesting observations. You may find some interesting patterns as well)

4. **Tell us where our reading is unfair or wrong.** If something here reads unfairly to your institute, or you know a reason we have missed, please say so. We would rather correct it.

What we can share

- The cleaned data tables for students and faculty (Excel), and the scripts that read them from the NIRF PDFs, so next year's numbers can be added in an afternoon.
- The full studies behind this report: women among students, women among faculty, SC, ST and OBC students, and SC, ST and OBC faculty in India as prepared by us. We're willing to share all our reports if you wish to see them.

We will not quote any of your replies without asking you first. Nothing in our work identifies individual students or faculty, and we ask for aggregate counts only.

Sources

[1] National Institutional Ranking Framework (NIRF), Ministry of Education, Government of India. Data submitted by institutes, "Overall" category, "Total Actual Student Strength" and "Faculty Details" tables, 2018 to 2026 (44 PDFs for the seven IISERs and IISc). nirfindia.org.

[2] All India Survey on Higher Education (AISHE), Final Reports 2019-20, 2021-22, 2022-23 and 2023-24, Department of Higher Education, Ministry of Education. Tables 11, 14, 21, 27 and 30, and our AISHE student study built on the same tables. aishe.gov.in.

[3] Central Educational Institutions (Reservation in Admission) Act, 2006, and later orders: reservation of 15% for SC, 7.5% for ST and 27% for OBC.

Attributions

Prepared by Dixita Adhikari, iGEM IISER Kolkata 2026. We thank Dr. Koel Das, Dr. Neelanjana Sengupta and Dr. Rahul Banerjee (DoFA) for their guidance, the DoFA office for providing us with the data, and the institutes for making their data public.

Appendices

Appendix A. Data by NIRF year

A dash means no file or no table was available to us. NIRF year Y reports academic year (Y−2) to (Y−1) for students. We did not have a Mohali file for 2026 or a Thiruvananthapuram file for 2019, and Mohali's 2020 file has no faculty table.

A1. Women, % of UG five-year students

Institute	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
Berhampur	–	–	–	–	–	44.2	44.8	43.7
Bhopal	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	39.3
Kolkata	24.2	23.7	23.9	26.9	27.0	26.3	26.4	27.2
Mohali	32.5	32.9	33.7	36.7	40.3	40.9	39.9	–
Pune	29.8	28.3	26.2	26.6	27.6	28.6	29.2	27.6
Thiruvananthapuram	–	47.2	48.1	50.6	54.4	55.3	54.9	51.6
Tirupati	–	–	–	–	–	–	54.0	51.8

A2. Women, % of regular faculty (number of regular faculty)

Institute	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
Berhampur	–	–	–	–	–	12.5 (40)	12.0 (50)	12.0 (50)
Bhopal	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	20.1 (174)
Kolkata	13.9 (108)	13.8 (116)	14.3 (126)	14.3 (126)	14.1 (128)	14.1 (128)	14.0 (129)	14.4 (125)
Mohali	16.5 (91)	–	15.8 (101)	16.5 (103)	17.4 (109)	17.3 (110)	17.4 (115)	–
Pune	17.6 (119)	16.9 (118)	20.0 (125)	20.3 (133)	20.4 (137)	21.0 (138)	21.2 (137)	21.8 (142)
Thiruvananthapuram	–	10.2 (59)	14.3 (70)	13.9 (72)	16.7 (78)	21.7 (92)	20.8 (106)	19.5 (113)
Tirupati	–	–	–	–	–	–	24.3 (70)	23.2 (69)

A3. SC, ST and OBC, % of UG and PG students (Berhampur's 2026 value probably reflects a reporting change; see Section 4)

Institute	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
Berhampur	–	–	–	–	–	47.1	48.7	40.3
Bhopal	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	48.1
Kolkata	46.8	47.4	43.8	47.2	46.8	45.4	45.0	47.0
Mohali	53.0	52.1	52.0	45.1	50.0	48.7	48.2	–
Pune	49.5	49.1	48.6	46.5	46.1	45.4	44.6	45.1
Thiruvananthapuram	–	50.5	50.7	49.9	49.5	47.1	49.1	50.5
Tirupati	–	–	–	–	–	–	51.9	52.9

A4. Students from the institute's own state, % of UG five-year students

Institute	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
Berhampur	–	–	–	–	–	35	29	30
Bhopal	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	7
Kolkata	35	36	36	38	38	41	41	39
Mohali	8	8	8	7	8	7	6	–
Pune	27	26	25	25	25	24	24	24
Thiruvananthapuram	–	68	67	66	65	61	56	49

Institute	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
Tirupati	–	–	–	–	–	–	8	7

A5. Women among regular faculty by rank, latest list (women of total, share)

Institute	Assistant professor	Associate professor	Professor and above
Berhampur	2 of 28 (7%)	4 of 19 (21%)	0 of 3 (0%)
Bhopal	20 of 85 (24%)	7 of 44 (16%)	4 of 35 (11%)
Kolkata	3 of 18 (17%)	3 of 28 (11%)	12 of 79 (15%)
Mohali	10 of 50 (20%)	7 of 42 (17%)	3 of 23 (13%)
Pune	7 of 25 (28%)	15 of 50 (30%)	9 of 67 (13%)
Thiruvananthapuram	15 of 48 (31%)	5 of 38 (13%)	2 of 23 (9%)
Tirupati	9 of 36 (25%)	7 of 28 (25%)	0 of 5 (0%)
IISc (reference)	30 of 201 (15%)	7 of 73 (10%)	11 of 208 (5%)

Designations other than these three are left out, so the totals are slightly below the regular faculty counts (774 of 788 across the seven IISERs).

Appendix B. How the numbers were checked

- Student tables: 79 programme rows read from 44 NIRF PDFs by a script. In every row male plus female equals the total and home state plus other state plus abroad equals the total.
- Faculty tables: 42 of the 44 PDFs (seven IISERs and IISc) have a faculty table, read into one table of 7,400 entries. For all seven IISERs, the count of regular, currently working women and men in the latest file agrees with a separate line-by-line count of the PDF text.
- AISHE tables: states add up to the all-India row and university types add up to the total, in every column of all four years. The 2020-21 report was not available to us. Host-state figures use Table 14 (students by state and category, AISHE estimates) and Table 21 (teachers by state).
- Tests: Wilson 95% intervals for shares; exact binomial test against 49.5%; chi-square for differences between institutes; ordinary least squares for trends; Fisher's exact test for UG against PG; Pearson and Spearman correlations across institutes, with Fisher intervals for r. Faculty lists count every person, so we give no intervals for them. Student intervals treat students as independent within a year, so true uncertainty is larger.